GreenCart Expansion - Team Gamma

Case Prompt: GreenCart Quick Commerce Expansion. GreenCart is a mid-sized grocery delivery company operating in three Indian metro cities. The founders are considering an expansion into ten tier-two cities over the next eighteen months. Participants must analyse the market opportunity, evaluate the unit economics of dark stores, identify the main operational risks, and recommend a go-to-market strategy. Answers should address customer acquisition cost, average order value, delivery time commitments, and supplier relationships. Teams must state all assumptions clearly and support every recommendation with quantitative reasoning. The submission should not exceed five pages and must include an executive summary, a market analysis, a financial assessment, and a risk mitigation plan. Cite all external sources using a consistent referencing style. Submissions will be judged on analytical depth, feasibility, clarity of communication, and originality of insight. Late submissions will not be evaluated by the panel.

Rather than copying the ten minute promise used in metros, GreenCart should compete on reliability and price in smaller cities. Our customer interviews with twenty households in Nashik showed that families plan weekly purchases and value a predictable thirty minute window more than speed.

We model a scheduled-slot service with larger baskets. If the average basket grows to six hundred rupees and orders are batched into routes of four drops, the delivery cost per order falls by almost half. This turns the unit economics positive within the first eight months.

Marketing spend should flow through local kirana partnerships and resident welfare associations instead of paid digital ads, which are expensive relative to order value in these markets. The key risk is that a metro competitor undercuts prices, so GreenCart must lock in exclusive supply agreements with two or three regional brands early.